

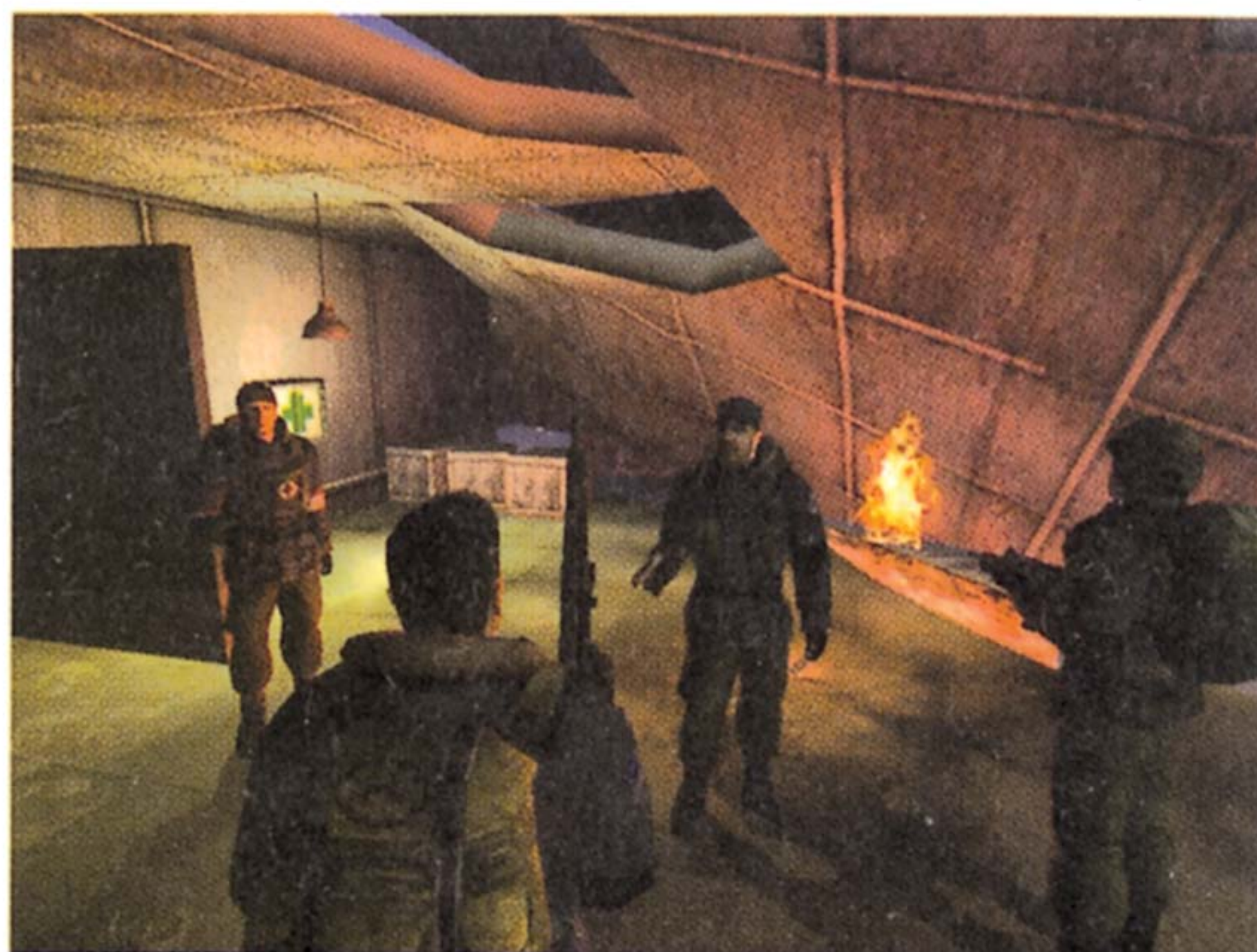


The Thing

That thing you do

Based on the John Carpenter movie of the same name (a Kurt Russel starrer), *The Thing* is a third person action-adventure game. Following the disaster that ended the movie, you and your crack team are sent to investigate a scientific outpost in the Antarctic. This game succeeds in recreating the doom and gloom ambience of the movie. Although you play as a part of a team, good use of graphics and dark slow-filled environs lend a deep sense of solitude to the gameplay. The attention to detail in all aspects of the game is commendable—your feet leave footprints in the snow, flares correctly light up teammates faces and the use of good quality textures helps in suspending disbelief.

Trust forms the anchor point of the game. The key is to control your teammates and gain their trust while going through the regular motions of a shooter game—killing baddies (which come in grotesque forms, both small and gargantuan) and collecting health kits. To gain the trust of your comrades, you need to help them when they're hurt, provide



THE ANTARCTIC SCOUT CAMPFIRE: Pay attention to the shadows and lighting, there's something to be learned here

them with weapons and ammunition, cover their backs and generally make sure that their needs (which are communicated with the help of emoticons) are fulfilled. A non-trusting member of the team might refuse to obey your order or even worse, turn his gun on you. Your teammates run the predictable gamut of

an engineer (to repair stuff), a doctor (to fix you up) and the gung-ho, trigger-happy type to watch your back. Clearing an area will require their services: the engineer will repair a power terminal to gain access to an area, for which you might need to gain his trust by administering some first-aid that only a doctor can provide, and so on. The teammates thus form a puzzle-like element of the game and lend it a very interesting and gripping play.

The game does tend to get mundane and repetitive as it progresses. A part of the reason being the snow-filled environ-

ment; besides the fact that monsters are a none-too frequent occurrence. So you spend most of your time doing mundane tasks such as hunting for keys and trying to gain access to the next room and so on. Although the elements that form the game are not very original, their execution is handled with much aplomb.

Minimum System Requirements: P-II 400 MHz, 64 MB RAM, 8 MB video card, 600 MB hard disk space ■ **Genre:** Action-Adventure
Developer: Black Label Games ■ **Distributor:** Worldwide CD-ROMs ■ **Phone:** 022-6973894/95 ■ **Web site:** www.thethinggames.com
Price: Rs 1,299 ■ **Rating:** ★★★★★

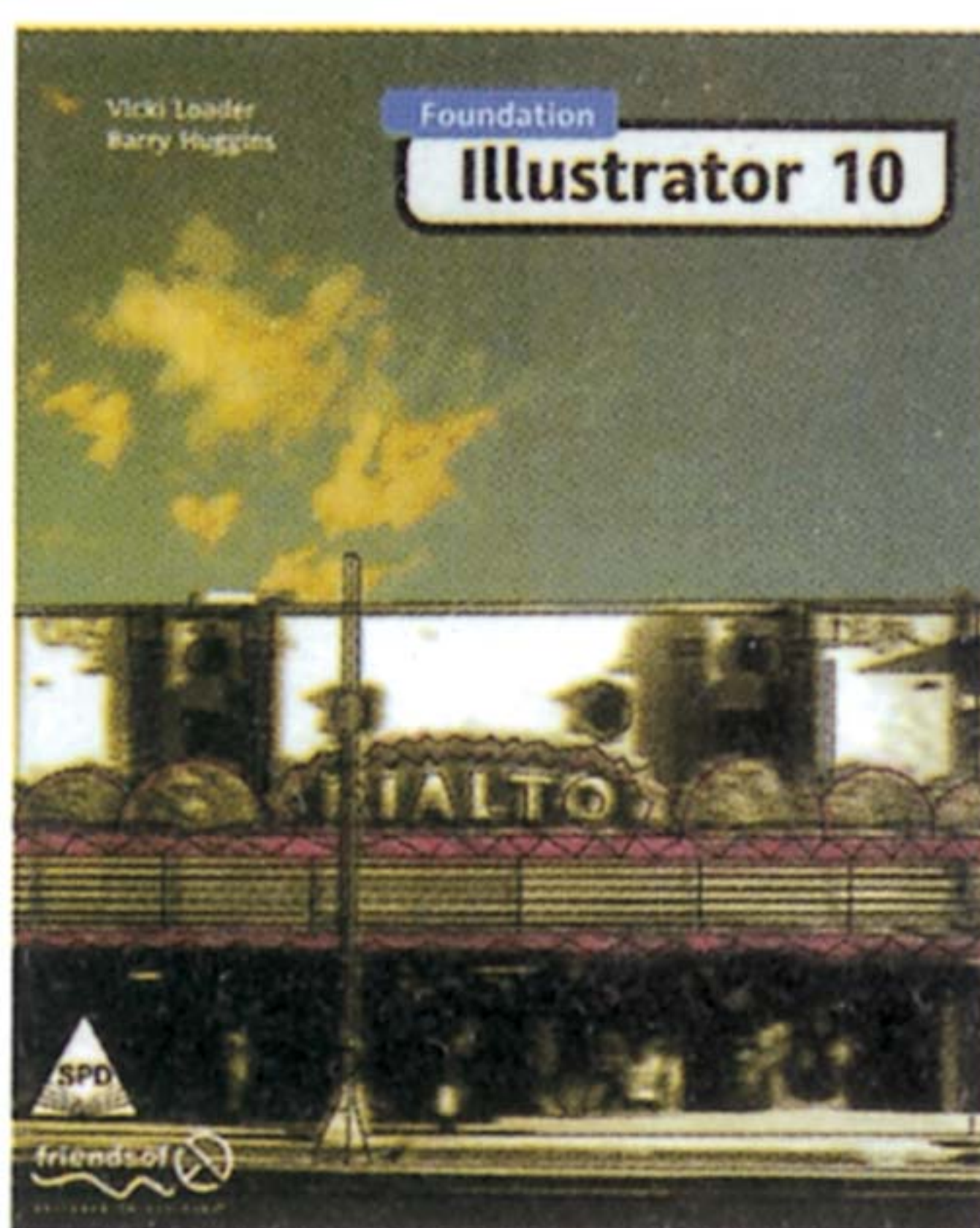


FOUNDATION ILLUSTRATOR 10

Hands on Illustrator

Foundation Illustrator 10, as the name suggests, takes an authoritative approach at the latest enhanced version of Adobe's Vector Graphics, Illustrator 10. The book concentrates mainly on two kinds of users—those who are already familiar with the previous version of Illustrator and those who are looking for something to spice up their creativity.

The book takes you through the pro-



help of detailed illustrations. The book

gram with the help of detailed step by step tutorials, accompanied by clear visuals. It covers efficiency-increasing areas like how to organise your artwork, techniques for bringing out the best in your creativity, benefits of using the said package and how to apply complex effects into your artwork. Each of the areas is explained with the

also gives a hands-on examination of each tool in the Illustrator toolbox.

Foundation Illustrator 10 is useful for designers who perform multiple tasks and generate graphics to be effectively used in both, the print and the Web media. Photoshop users will also find this book informative in the area of vector graphics and can integrate it for more productive output. Overall, *Foundation Illustrator 10* is an informative and descriptive buy for those already established in the profession and who are looking for a sprucing of their skills as well as those who want to step into the world of designing armed with know-how.

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Fax: 022-2623551 ■ **E-mail:** cbsbom@giasbm01.vsnl.net.in ■ **Price:** Rs 375 ■ **Rating:** ★★★★★